

SHEBAL SOLUTIONS PVT. LTD.

Employee HR Policy Handbook

Synthetic policy document prepared for an academic RAG chatbot prototype

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About this Handbook

This handbook is a fictional and synthetic HR policy knowledge base created for a prototype employee-query chatbot. It is not an official policy of any real organization. The structure is inspired by common employee handbooks and the headings in the reference induction manual supplied for the project.

The purpose of the handbook is to give the RAG system enough realistic policy content to retrieve relevant sections and answer employee questions in a grounded manner.

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1. Company Overview

Shebal Solutions Pvt. Ltd. is a fictional technology-enabled business services company with offices in Mumbai, Pune and Bengaluru. The company provides digital operations, analytics, customer support and business process solutions to clients across India. The company aims to create a professional, inclusive and learning-oriented workplace.

2. Employee Documentation and Onboarding

Employees must submit required joining documents within seven calendar days of joining. HR may request originals for verification.

- Signed appointment letter
- Government-issued identity proof
- Address proof

- Educational qualification documents
- Previous employment relieving or experience letters, where applicable
- Bank account and tax-related information
- Recent photograph and emergency contact details

Employees are responsible for ensuring that information submitted to HR is complete and accurate. Material misrepresentation may lead to disciplinary action.

3. Leave Policy

The leave year runs from January to December. Leave should be applied through the employee self-service portal and approved by the reporting manager before the employee proceeds on leave, except in emergencies.

3.1 Privilege / Earned Leave

- 18 days of Privilege Leave are credited each calendar year for confirmed employees.
- Privilege Leave should normally be applied at least 7 days in advance.
- Up to 30 unutilized days may be carried forward to the next year.
- Employees on probation are not eligible for Privilege Leave during the first three months.

3.2 Casual Leave

- 8 days of Casual Leave are available each calendar year.
- Casual Leave may be used for short personal requirements or unforeseen situations.
- A maximum of 3 consecutive days may normally be availed at one time.
- Unused Casual Leave lapses at year-end and is not encashable.

3.3 Sick Leave

- 10 days of Sick Leave are available each calendar year.
- A medical certificate may be requested for absence of more than 3 consecutive working days.
- Unused Sick Leave may be accumulated up to a maximum of 30 days.

3.4 Maternity and Parental Leave

- Maternity leave will be provided in accordance with applicable law and company rules.
- Eligible employees may receive up to 26 weeks of maternity leave, subject to statutory conditions.
- Paternity leave of 5 working days may be availed within 60 days of the birth or adoption of a child.

3.5 Emergency Leave

In an emergency, an employee should inform the reporting manager as soon as reasonably possible and regularize the leave request within 2 working days of resuming duty.

4. Working Hours and Attendance

- Normal office hours are 9:30 a.m. to 6:30 p.m., Monday to Friday.

- Employees are expected to complete a minimum of 8 working hours excluding the meal break, unless a different shift is assigned.
- A 45-minute meal break is allowed.
- Attendance is recorded through the designated digital attendance system or office access system.
- Employees should report missed attendance records to HR within 24 hours.
- Repeated late coming, unauthorized absence or attendance misuse may lead to counselling or disciplinary action.

4.1 Hybrid Work

- Eligible corporate employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week with manager approval.
- Business requirements and client confidentiality take priority over remote-work preferences.
- Employees must remain reachable during core working hours while working remotely.

5. Salary and Payroll

- Salary is processed monthly and credited to the employee's registered bank account.
- Payslips are made available through the employee self-service portal.
- Statutory deductions and contributions are processed as applicable.
- Employees must review salary discrepancies and report them to Payroll within 7 working days of receipt of the payslip.
- Bonus or variable pay, where applicable, is governed by the employee's compensation structure and company performance criteria.

6. Dress, Communication and Confidentiality

6.1 Dress and Appearance

Employees are expected to maintain neat, professional and role-appropriate attire. Business formal or business casual attire may be required based on client interactions or departmental requirements.

6.2 Professional Communication

- Employees must communicate respectfully with colleagues, customers, vendors and managers.
- Official email and messaging systems should primarily be used for business purposes.
- Harassing, discriminatory, threatening or offensive communication is prohibited.

6.3 Confidentiality and Data Protection

- Employees must protect confidential company, client and employee information.
- Confidential information should not be shared with unauthorized persons or external platforms.
- Employees must follow approved information-security and access-control procedures.
- Suspected data loss or security incidents must be reported immediately to the IT or Information Security team.

7. Probation and Confirmation

- New employees are normally appointed on probation for 6 months.
- Performance and conduct may be reviewed during the probation period.
- The company may confirm employment, extend probation by up to 3 months, or discontinue employment in accordance with the appointment terms and applicable law.
- Confirmation is effective only after formal communication from HR.

8. Diversity and Equal Opportunity

- Shebal Solutions is committed to equal employment opportunity and a respectful workplace.
- Employment decisions should not be based on race, religion, caste, gender, disability, age, marital status, sexual orientation or other protected characteristics.
- Discrimination, harassment, bullying and victimization are prohibited.
- Reasonable workplace accommodation may be considered where required and feasible.

9. Grievance Redressal

Employees may raise work-related concerns without fear of retaliation. Grievances may relate to workplace treatment, manager behaviour, working conditions, policy interpretation, interpersonal conflicts or employment-related concerns.

- Step 1: Employee may discuss the concern with the reporting manager, where appropriate.
- Step 2: If unresolved, the employee may submit the grievance in writing to HR.
- Step 3: HR will acknowledge the grievance and initiate fact-finding.
- Step 4: The employee will be informed of the outcome or next steps.
- Step 5: An appeal may be escalated to the designated senior HR authority.

The company will aim to close ordinary grievances within 30 calendar days, subject to complexity and availability of information.

10. Prevention of Sexual Harassment

Shebal Solutions is committed to a workplace free from sexual harassment. Complaints will be handled confidentially and in accordance with applicable law and internal procedures.

- Employees may report concerns to the designated Internal Committee or HR contact.
- Retaliation against a complainant, witness or participant in an inquiry is prohibited.
- Knowingly false or malicious complaints may be addressed through appropriate disciplinary procedures, without discouraging genuine complaints.
- Interim workplace measures may be considered where necessary during an inquiry.

11. Change of Personal Information

Employees must promptly update HR or the self-service portal when there is a change in personal information, including name, address, phone number, emergency contact, bank account, marital status, dependent information or qualifications.

12. Performance Management

- Formal performance reviews are conducted annually, with periodic check-ins encouraged throughout the year.
- Performance discussions may cover goals, key responsibilities, behavioural competencies, achievements, development needs and future priorities.
- Employees and managers are expected to discuss goals and feedback openly.
- Where performance is below expectations, the manager and HR may use coaching, documented development actions or a Performance Improvement Plan.

13. Learning and Development

- Employees may be nominated for role-based, technical, behavioural or leadership development programs.
- Mandatory compliance training must be completed within the prescribed timelines.
- Employees are encouraged to maintain an Individual Development Plan in discussion with their manager.
- Training participation does not automatically guarantee promotion or role change.

14. Employee Benefits and Well-being

- Eligible employees are covered under company-sponsored group medical insurance as per plan rules.
- The company may offer wellness sessions, counselling support and preventive health initiatives.
- Provident fund, gratuity and other statutory benefits are administered as applicable.
- Benefits may vary by grade, location and employment category.

15. Separation and Notice Period

- Employees who resign must submit written resignation through the designated process.
- The standard notice period for employees up to Manager level is 60 days unless the appointment letter specifies otherwise.
- Senior roles may have a 90-day notice period.
- Notice-period waiver or buyout is subject to management approval and appointment terms.
- Employees must complete handover, return company assets, clear outstanding dues and complete exit formalities before final settlement.
- Experience and relieving documents are issued after completion of required exit clearances.

16. Employee Self-Service Portal and Employee Code

- Every employee receives a unique employee code after successful onboarding.
- The employee self-service portal may be used for leave applications, attendance review, payslips, tax declarations, personal-information updates and access to HR policies.
- Employees must keep login credentials secure and must not share passwords.
- Policy updates communicated through the portal or official company communication supersede earlier versions where stated.

Important Disclaimer

This handbook is entirely fictional and has been created only for an academic / portfolio demonstration of a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) HR chatbot. The company name, policy values and procedures are synthetic and should not be treated as real legal or HR advice.